

Samsung Carcinogenic?

Although tough to prove, a report alleges that Samsung production plants may be causing Leukemia in workers

Good Virus!

MIT researchers have have trained a home grown virus to split water and produce storable solar power

Western Digital SiliconEdge Blue 256 GB

From steel to silicon

WDs first SSD we have received. It's a good looking drive with a metal body that makes it feel sturdy as well as look good, but adds weight – which shouldn't be a problem for desktop users. WD quotes reliability and compatibility over perform-

ance as this drives ethos at the very start. WD doesn't state who made the controller which is very important, but they do mention that the drive features 64 MB of DDR2 800 MHz memory – which is very fast even as a cache block. TRIM is supported.

Testing it, we had a chance to compare its scores to

**Specifications**

Capacity: 256 GB; Cache: 64 MB DDR2; Commands supported: TRIM

Contact

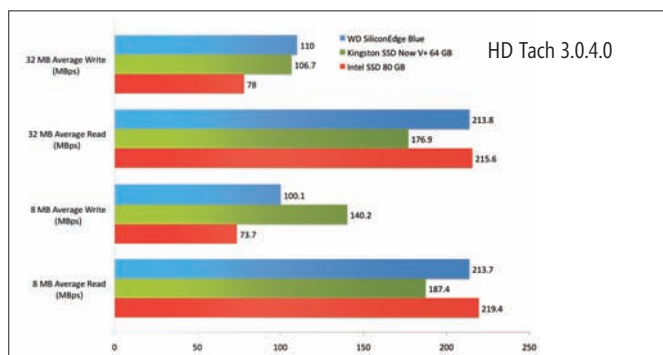
Western Digital Corp

Email:

amarjeet.singh@wdc.com

Web site: www.wdc.com

Price: Rs. 58,250

**Specifications**

Core speed: 3.33 GHz; No of cores: 2 (4 with hyper-threading); L2 cache: 512 KB; L2 cache: 4 MB

Contact

Intel APAC Support

Phone: +91-80-2854 2105

Email: apacsupport@mailbox.intel.com

Web site:

www.intel.com/in

Price: Rs. 13,500

Intel Core i5 661

Cool, affordable and fast

Intel's Core i5 processors haven't seen the limelight for inexplicable reasons. The 661 is built on a 32nm process that helps it run really cool while running at a blistering 3.33 GHz. This is regular stuff, however, and what makes the CPU really special is the addition of an integrated GPU on the CPU die. This CPU is based on a 1156 LGA socket and although P55 boards are supported, it's obviously designed for the newer Intel H55 and H57 chipsets that can make use of the integrated graphic solution. Testing the i5 661 we must say

it's very cool – the CPU never crossed 41 degrees throughout our testing.

The Maxon Cinebench R10 score of 8,586 is even higher than the similarly clocked Core 2 Duo E8600 (7,107) – another dual core from the older Core 2 Duo family. The WinRAR 3.9 score of 2,051 is higher than the 1,802 scored by the E8600. A 100 MB.VOB file was converted to the .divx format in 51 seconds – while this isn't record breaking stuff, it's still fairly fast. Priced at Rs. 13,500, the Core i5 661 is



expensive – and this is the only sore spot we have. After all, if you wanted power, you could buy a Core i7 860 for the same price – and that would outperform this. The i5 661s inbuilt graphics chip is also a factor however, and is decent scoring a 2061 in 3D Mark 2006. We cannot recommend it at this price point – for it is not a value proposition.

6.5/10

Features..... 7.5
Performance 7
Build quality 8.5
Value for money..... 4.5

6.5/10

Features..... 8
Performance 7.5
Value for money..... 5